TECHNOVA

Leave Policy 2026

Effective Date: January 1, 2026

Version: 1.0

Approved By: Board of Directors

Introduction and Scope

1.0 Introduction

At Technova, we believe that clear guidelines regarding time off help maintain both professional clarity and personal well-being.

1.1 Purpose and Scope

This document defines the official leave policies and procedural frameworks for all employees at Technova. The clear goal of this policy is to deliver a fair, transparent, and consistent system for managing employee time off. It ensures that every team member understands their personal time entitlements and the exact steps required to submit a request. This framework supports personal well-being while protecting day-to-day business operations and client deadlines. This policy completely supersedes any previous leave agreements, whether written or spoken.

1.2 Our Philosophy on Work-Life Balance

We recognize that our people are Technova's most valuable asset. We are fully committed to fostering an open, supportive work environment that highlights a healthy work-life balance. Adequate rest and regular time away from work are essential for long-term health, daily morale, creative engagement, and engineering productivity. Our leave guidelines provide the flexibility needed to handle family needs, explore personal interests, and return to work recharged.

1.3 Applicability

This policy applies directly to all full-time and part-time permanent employees of Technova. Contractual staff, temporary workers, and interns may operate under different leave terms outlined specifically in their individual employment agreements. Provisions may adjust dynamically based on local labor laws in the jurisdictions where we operate. In any scenario where a conflict arises, local labor law will take priority.

1.4 Key Definitions

- **Employee:** Any individual employed by Technova on a permanent full-time or part-time basis.
- **Manager:** A team member holding direct supervisory responsibility for other employees.
- **HR Department:** The internal Human Resources department at Technova.
- **HRIS:** The Human Resources Information System platform used to log requests and manage leave balances.
- **Leave Year:** The official twelve-month calculation cycle, running from January 1st to December 31st.
- **Accrual:** The ongoing process of earning time-off credits over a set period of service.
- **Medical Practitioner:** A licensed and registered doctor or healthcare professional.

General Leave Guidelines

2.0 General Leave Provisions

These standard provisions govern how leave is tracked, submitted, and managed throughout the calendar year.

2.1 The Leave Year

The official leave year at Technova matches the calendar year, beginning January 1, 2026, and concluding December 31, 2026. All calculations are based on this window. For any employee joining Technova mid-year, their time-off entitlements will be prorated based on their remaining months of active service.

2.2 Procedure for Requesting Leave

All time-off requests, excluding sudden emergencies like illness, must be submitted in advance through the company's HRIS portal. When logging a request, employees must clearly input the specific leave type, start date, end date, and any helpful notes for the reviewer. Verbal notices or email updates are excellent for initial team communication but do not count as official submissions. An official HRIS request must be entered as soon as it is practical to do so.

2.3 Approval Workflow

Requests entered into the HRIS route directly to the employee's line manager for evaluation. Managers must review these requests promptly, balancing individual requests against team workload, upcoming product deadlines, and operational coverage. If a direct manager is out of the office, a designated alternate approver will handle incoming requests. Employees receive automated alerts when a request is approved or denied. If a request is turned down, the manager must provide a clear reason.

2.4 Leave Balance and Accrual

Team members can verify their live balances, accrual history, and upcoming time projections anytime via the self-service dashboard in the HRIS. Leave credits accrue steadily on a monthly or bi-weekly basis depending on your specific payroll cycle.

Balances, Probation, and Departures

2.5 Leave Carry-Forward

Technova actively encourages every employee to use their complete vacation allocation during the 2026 calendar year. If business needs or personal schedules get in the way, the following rules apply:

- **Paid Time Off (PTO):** A maximum of 5 unused PTO days can carry forward into the 2027 leave year.
- **Sick Leave:** Unused sick leave can carry forward up to a maximum safety cap of 45 days to support employees during unforeseen, long-term medical situations.
- **Deadlines:** Any carried-forward leave must be used within the first quarter of the new year (by March 31, 2027) or it will officially lapse.

2.6 Leave Encashment

Because we value rest and recovery, Technova does not permit cash payouts for leave days during your active employment. Upon formal separation from the company, any accrued and unused PTO will be paid out in your final settlement package according to local laws.

2.7 Leave During Probation Period

Employees currently serving their introductory probation period will accrue leave credits according to standard policy. However, taking elective PTO during the first 90 days is generally discouraged and remains subject to strict manager discretion. Sick leave and statutory options remain fully available if needed.

2.8 Leave During Notice Period

Once an employee enters their resignation notice period, elective leave is generally not permitted. Exceptions are made only for verified medical emergencies. Pre-planned leave may be reviewed by management and HR on a case-by-case basis. Technova reserves the right to extend the notice period by the exact number of leave days taken.

2.9 Unauthorized Absence

An unexcused absence lasting three or more consecutive business days without any notification to a manager or HR is considered an unauthorized absence. This is handled as job abandonment and can result in disciplinary action up to immediate termination.

2.10 Contact During Leave

When on leave, you should disconnect from work entirely. Set up an out-of-office auto-reply on your email and messaging channels detailing alternative team contacts. Managers will only reach out to an employee on leave during a genuine, critical business emergency that no one else can resolve.

Paid Time Off (PTO)

3.0 Paid Time Off (PTO) / Annual Leave

PTO gives our team regular, paid windows to step away from daily tasks to rest, travel, handle personal logistics, or recharge.

3.1 Purpose

Paid Time Off is vital for maintaining high performance and personal health. We want you to use this time for deliberate rest.

3.2 Eligibility and Entitlement

All permanent Technova employees are eligible for paid annual leave. Your total yearly entitlement scales based on your continuous tenure with the company:

- **0 to 2 Years of Service:** 18 days of annual PTO.
- **2 to 5 Years of Service:** 22 days of annual PTO.
- **5+ Years of Service:** 25 days of annual PTO.
- **Part-Time Staff:** Entitlements are prorated cleanly based on contracted working hours.

3.3 Accrual Schedule

PTO builds up progressively each month. For instance, a team member with an 18-day annual allowance will see exactly 1.5 days of PTO added to their balance at the completion of each full month of service.

3.4 Planning and Scheduling PTO

- **Short Leave:** For time off lasting fewer than 5 consecutive business days, log your request at least two weeks in advance.
- **Long Leave:** For absences of 5 or more business days, log your request at least four weeks in advance.
- **Blackout Windows:** During peak product launches or critical client deployment periods, Technova may temporarily restrict elective PTO requests to ensure coverage.
- **Increments:** PTO must be taken in minimum blocks of a half-day (4 hours).
- **Negative Balances:** Employees cannot run a negative leave balance; your requested time off must not exceed your current accrued balance.

3.5 PTO Case Study: Planning a Vacation

- **Scenario:** Sarah has crossed 3 years of service at Technova (giving her 22 annual days) and wants to take a 10-day summer vacation.
- **Action:** Six weeks before her trip, Sarah checks her HRIS portal and confirms she has 12 accrued days available. She enters a formal 10-day request. Her manager reviews the project timeline, confirms team coverage is sufficient, and approves it. Sarah configures her out-of-office notice and logs off cleanly.

: Sick Leave Guidelines

4.0 Sick Leave

Sick leave ensures that employees can prioritize their health or care for immediate family members during unexpected illness or medical situations without financial worry.

4.1 Purpose

This leave is strictly allocated for recovery from unexpected personal illness, injury, or to attend essential medical appointments.

4.2 Entitlement

All full-time employees receive 12 days of paid sick leave at the start of each calendar year. Sick leave does not accrue monthly; the full 12-day balance is available immediately on January 1, 2026 (or prorated appropriately if you join Technova mid-year).

4.3 Notification Procedure

If you are too unwell to perform your duties, inform your direct manager via call, text, or email as early as possible—ideally before your scheduled start time. A formal sick leave request must be entered into the HRIS portal on the day you call out or immediately upon your physical return to work.

4.4 Medical Certification Requirements

- **Consecutive Days:** For any medical call-out lasting three or more consecutive business days, you must upload a doctor's note from a registered medical practitioner into the HRIS.
- **Certificate Details:** The note must explicitly state the dates you were unfit for duty. To protect your personal privacy, it should not reveal private diagnostic details.
- **Short Absences:** Technova reserves the right to request a formal medical note for shorter absences if an employee shows a recurring pattern of frequent short-term call-outs.

4.5 Long-Term Sickness and Returning to Work

If a severe medical issue requires an extended absence, contact HR to discuss structured options, such as corporate disability benefits or an extended unpaid leave of absence. For medical absences that exceed 10 consecutive business days, you must provide a formal fitness-to-work certificate before resuming active duties to ensure you can return safely.

4.6 Sick Leave Case Study: Handling an Illness

- **Scenario:** John wakes up on a Tuesday morning with a severe fever and cannot work.
- **Action:** At 8:00 AM, John sends a message to his manager detailing his illness. His recovery takes four days. On Monday, his first day back, he opens the HRIS, logs a 4-day sick leave request, and uploads a digital scan of his doctor's note.

Public Holidays and Parental Leaves

5.0 Public Holidays

Technova provides paid time off for designated public holidays every year.

5.1 Official Holiday Schedule

The company observes 10 paid public holidays each year. The official operational calendar and observed dates are published by HR at the start of January. Permanent employees receive full pay for these days.

5.2 Floating Holidays

When public holidays fall on weekends, Technova will designate an alternate weekday off or provide floating holiday credits, allowing teams to maintain a balanced rest schedule.

6.0 Maternity Leave

We provide robust support frameworks for expecting mothers to ensure peace of mind during childbirth and early infant care.

6.1 Purpose and Eligibility

All permanent full-time female employees are eligible for fully paid Maternity Leave. This policy ensures adequate recovery time and bonding space without impacting career continuity.

6.2 Duration and Application

Maternity leave duration complies fully with or exceeds regional statutory minimums. Employees should submit an application in the HRIS at least four weeks before their expected leave date, attaching basic medical documentation from their doctor. All standard insurance and employment

benefits continue uninterrupted throughout the leave window. A formal return-to-work plan can be coordinated with HR to ensure a smooth ramp-up.

7.0 Paternity Leave

Technova recognizes the vital role of partners during the arrival of a new child.

7.1 Eligibility and Pay

All permanent employees welcoming a new child via birth or legal adoption are eligible for paid Paternity Leave. This leave provides full salary coverage for a designated period, allowing parents to focus entirely on family bonding. Requests should be submitted through the HRIS portal ahead of time, ensuring clear coordination with your direct team.

Bereavement and Civic Duties

8.0 Bereavement Leave

We provide compassionate, paid time off to support employees navigating the loss of a loved one.

8.1 Purpose and Entitlement

Permanent employees are eligible for paid Bereavement Leave following the passing of an immediate or extended family member. This time is provided so employees can attend services, handle personal logistics, and grieve with family.

8.2 Family Definitions and Procedures

Immediate family includes spouses, children, parents, and siblings. Extended family definitions cover grandparents, parents-in-law, and legal guardians. Employees must notify their manager as soon as possible and log the request in the HRIS upon their return. Technova prioritizes empathy over paperwork, though basic documentation may be requested if needed for administrative records.

9.0 Jury Duty and Civic Responsibility Leave

Technova fully supports our team members in fulfilling their civic duties and legal obligations.

9.1 Purpose and Pay

We provide fully paid Civic Leave when an employee is officially summoned for jury duty, called as a witness, or required by law to participate in public service. Technova will maintain your regular salary for the duration of your verified civic service.

9.2 Documentation

Employees must upload a copy of the official court summons or civic notice into the HRIS as soon as they receive it. If your civic service finishes early on any given day, you are expected to check in with your manager or resume remote work if practical.

Unpaid Leave and Compassionate Care

10.0 Unpaid Leave of Absence (LOA)

An Unpaid Leave of Absence allows employees to take extended time away from work for exceptional personal reasons when their accrued paid leave balances are exhausted.

10.1 Eligibility and Review

Permanent employees who have completed their introductory probation period can apply for an unpaid LOA. Every application is evaluated individually based on the underlying reason, current team workloads, and overall business impacts.

10.2 Application Process

Requests must be submitted in writing to your manager and HR at least four weeks in advance, detailing the desired duration and reason for the request. Taking an unapproved unpaid absence will be managed as an unauthorized departure from your role.

10.3 Impact on Benefits

During an extended unpaid LOA, regular salary payments stop. Depending on the length of the absence, certain company-sponsored benefits or insurance accruals may be paused or adjusted in accordance with local labor laws. Your exact return date and role continuity parameters will be confirmed in writing by HR before your leave begins.

11.0 Compassionate Leave

Compassionate leave provides dedicated flexibility for employees who need to step away to care for a loveSd one navigating a major medical crisis.

11.1 Purpose and Distinction

While Bereavement Leave applies specifically to the passing of a family member, Compassionate Leave is designed for critical care situations. It applies when an immediate family member suffers a sudden, life-threatening illness or severe physical injury, requiring the employee's direct presence and care. Log these requests through the HRIS, coordinating closely with HR for any extended care planning.

Special Categories and Responsibilities

12.0 Special Leave Categories

Technova provides additional structured leave categories to support unique personal or legal obligations.

12.1 Adoption Leave

To support teams expanding their families, our Adoption Leave policy offers matching time-off parameters to our standard parental leave frameworks, ensuring equitable support for all parents.

12.2 Voting Leave

Technova ensures all eligible employees have sufficient time to cast their ballots in local, state, or national elections. If your regular working hours overlap significantly with polling hours, coordinate with your manager to schedule paid time off to vote.

12.3 Military Service Leave

Employees called up for active or reserve military duty will receive a structured leave of absence matching all local statutory requirements, protecting their role continuity and seniority.

13.0 Roles and Responsibilities

Clear collaboration ensures our leave policies work smoothly across our engineering teams.

13.1 Employee Responsibilities

- Log all leave requests accurately and ahead of time within the HRIS portal.
- Communicate upcoming absences clearly to your team to protect project delivery.
- Set up clear out-of-office notices and hand over critical tasks before logging off.

13.2 Manager Responsibilities

- Review incoming leave requests fairly and promptly, keeping team metrics in mind.
- Support your team's work-life balance while ensuring operational commitments are met.
- Document clear, objective reasons in the HRIS if a time-off request must be denied.

13.3 HR Department Responsibilities

- Maintain and update leave frameworks to stay aligned with shifting labor laws.
- Provide clear guidance to managers and teams on complex leave scenarios.
- Securely manage all sensitive medical notes and certification records with strict confidentiality.

FAQs and Administration

14.0 Policy Administration

This policy is managed neutrally to ensure consistent, fair application across all business units.

14.1 Exceptions and Confidentiality

Any exception to the guidelines in this document requires formal written approval from the Head of HR and the Executive Leadership Team. All health records, medical notes, and personal justifications shared for leave approvals are treated with high confidentiality and stored securely apart from standard corporate directories.

15.0 Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Q1: How do I submit a time-off request? A: All leave must be logged through the company's HRIS portal. Head to the "Time Off" dashboard, choose your leave category, input your desired dates, and submit it to your manager for digital approval.

Q2: Can my direct manager turn down a PTO request? A: Yes. While Technova encourages taking time off, approvals remain subject to active business needs. A manager may decline a request if it conflicts directly with critical delivery deadlines or if multiple team members have requested the same dates. Your manager must provide a clear reason and work with you to find a better time.

Q3: What happens if I get sick during a planned PTO vacation? A: If you fall ill for three or more consecutive days during your PTO and can provide a valid medical certificate, you can request to reclassify those specific days as Sick Leave. Notify your manager immediately and update your entry in the HRIS upon your return to credit those PTO days back to your balance.

Q4: Are public holidays paid days off? A: Yes, all officially designated public holidays are fully paid days off for permanent Technova staff.

16.0 Revision History

- **Version:** 2.0
- **Date of Revision:** January 1, 2026
- **Summary of Changes:** Updated comprehensive leave provisions and carry-forward timelines for the 2026 calendar year cycle.
- **Approved By:** Board of Directors.